

MOCK INTERVIEW ASSESSMENT REPORT

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INTERVIEW QUESTIONS AND RESPONSES

Q1

Question Asked: What is DNS, and why is it important in computer networks?

Student Response: DNS is domain name system. it is important because , It makes websites easier to access using **names** instead of numbers.

Q2

Question Asked: Explain the purpose of SMTP. How is SMTP different from a protocol used to retrieve emails?

Student Response: Smtip is used to send emails from one mail server to another or from a user's email client to a mail server. and smtp sends email and other protocols such as pop3 receives email

Q3

Question Asked: What is FTP, and give one practical example of where FTP can be used.

Student Response: FTP or file transfer protocol is a network protocol which is used to transfer files from one to another node over a network, eg: sending a file from computer to a web server.

Q4

Question Asked: What is HTTP, and explain how a web browser communicates with a web server using HTTP?

Student Response: HTTP stands for HyperText Transfer Protocol. It is used for communication between a web browser and a web server. When we enter a website address, the browser sends a request to the server. The server processes the request and sends the webpage back to the browser, which then displays it.

Q5

Question Asked: What is Electronic Mail (Email), and how do protocols such as SMTP and POP support email communication?

Student Response: Electronic Mail, or Email, is a way of sending and receiving messages over the Internet. SMTP is used to send emails from the sender to the mail server and between mail servers. POP is used to download emails from the mail server to the user's device.

Q6

Question Asked: What is P2P (Peer-to-Peer) communication? Explain how it differs from the traditional client-server model.

Student Response: P2P, or Peer-to-Peer communication, is a network model where computers communicate directly with each other and can both send and receive data. In the client-server model, the client requests services or data from a central server. In P2P, there is no single central server, and each computer can act as both a client and a server.

Q7

Question Asked: What is VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol), and how does it enable voice communication over a computer network?

Student Response: VoIP stands for Voice over Internet Protocol. It is a technology that allows us to make voice calls using the Internet instead of traditional telephone networks. It converts our voice into digital data and sends it over a computer network to the receiver.

Q8

Question Asked: What is an Overlay Network? Explain how it is different from the underlying physical network.

Student Response: An Overlay Network is a virtual network created on top of an existing physical network. It allows devices to communicate using a logical connection without changing the actual physical network.

The underlying physical network consists of the actual cables, routers, and switches, while the overlay network is a virtual layer built over it.

Q9

Question Asked: What is SSL, and how does it help protect communication over a network?

Student Response: SSL stands for Secure Sockets Layer. It is a security protocol that protects data when it is sent between a user's device and a server. It encrypts the data so that others cannot easily read or steal it during transmission.

Q10

Question Asked: A company's network is experiencing a large number of unwanted requests, making its services slow or unavailable to legitimate users. What type of network attack could this be, and what security mechanisms could be used to protect the network?

Student Response: This could be a DoS (Denial-of-Service) attack, or a DDoS (Distributed Denial-of-Service) attack if the requests are coming from many different devices. It makes the network or services slow or unavailable to legitimate users.

To protect the network, the company can use firewalls, intrusion detection and prevention systems (IDS/IPS), traffic filtering, and rate limiting. DDoS protection services can also help block large amounts of unwanted traffic.

QUESTION-WISE EVALUATION

Question	Technical Knowledge	Problem Solving	Analytical Thinking	Communication	Confidence	SubQ Total
Q1	Level 3	Level 2	Level 2	Level 3	Level 3	68.75
Q2	Level 4	Level 3	Level 3	Level 4	Level 3	82.50
Q3	Level 4	Level 3	Level 3	Level 4	Level 3	82.50
Q4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 3	90.00
Q5	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 3	90.00
Q6	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	100.00
Q7	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	100.00
Q8	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	100.00
Q9	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	100.00
Q10	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	Level 4	100.00

FINAL RUBRIC EVALUATION

Criterion	Weightage	Assigned Level	Marks Awarded
Technical Knowledge	25	Level 4	25
Problem Solving	25	Level 4	25
Analytical Thinking	20	Level 4	20

Communication	15	Level 4	15
Confidence	15	Level 3	11.25
Total	100		96.25

Student Average Final Mark: 91.38 / 100

OVERALL FEEDBACK

Strengths

- Demonstrated good understanding of application-layer protocols.
- Clearly distinguished SMTP and POP.
- Explained HTTP using a practical client-server example.
- Gave strong explanations of P2P, VoIP, and Overlay Networks.
- Q10 demonstrated particularly good analytical and problem-solving ability by distinguishing DoS from DDoS and suggesting multiple protection mechanisms.
- Responses were concise and used appropriate technical terminology.

Areas for Improvement

- Q1 could be more detailed by explaining the DNS resolution process.
- Some answers could include a practical example or additional justification.
- During the actual voice interview, maintain confident delivery and avoid very short answers.
- For security topics, be prepared to explain mechanisms such as SSL, firewalls, IDS/IPS, and DoS protection in greater depth.

Interview Readiness

Excellent ■